

Teacher notes and answers

Continents and oceans | BUILD_SU1_W05 | STAFF ONLY

Scheme of work alignment

Outcome: Talk about the wider world using continents and oceans.

Teaching and application: Use a globe and large map to locate the UK, continents and major oceans. Match labels together; independently identify a chosen continent and ocean using a reduced choice bank if needed.

Assessment: F: matching or labelling response and short retrieval check.

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Preparation

Use the original SVG labelled simplified teaching map, not to scale. It shows seven continents and five oceans, without country borders. The UK is marked by a small dot and callout in Europe; it is a country, not a continent. Use Australia as the continent name in this seven-continent convention. The Pacific appears at both edges of the flat map and is one ocean. Check a globe if available; the flat map distorts shapes and sizes.

Access and feedback

Give one instruction at a time. Offer pointing, speech, drawing, typing or writing. Use a reduced choice set if needed. Keep communication support and fade content prompts before the individual check.

Offer a two-card first choice, private pointing or an adult reading labels. No speed race or public score is needed.

Print only the chosen arrival and independent routes. Keep staff answers separate. Use a private response, read aloud, point, speak, draw or write. Record content prompting separately from access support.

Teaching sequence

Nine stages | 40 minutes, with flexible pauses

Stage	Min	Teaching and next attempt
Opening	0	Talk about the wider world using continents and oceans.
Arrival	4	Offer two choices, model one example and recheck with a new one.
Starter	3	Ask for one observation or label, then hear the revised response.
I do	6	Pause after each model step and invite a check.
We do	7	Use the paired routine, swap roles and hear each learner's reason.
Check	2	Ask the learner to repair the misconception and explain the change.
Independent	12	Keep access support while fading content prompts. Record each learner's own response.
Review	3	Give one precise next step and time for the learner to act on it.
Exit	3	Use the individual response to choose a revisit, consolidation or extension.

Worked model and preparation

Read before teaching

Question: Which continent contains the UK, and which ocean lies to its west?

Evidence: The UK dot is in Europe. The Atlantic Ocean label is to the left, west of Europe.

Explain: Europe is the continent. The Atlantic is the ocean to the west of the UK.

Check: Point to both labels. A globe shows that Earth is round; this map is simplified.

Practical setup

Use the original labelled SVG as a large reference and the unlabelled map plus cut-out cards for responses. A globe is optional; if unavailable, explain that Earth is round and the flat map has been opened out. The Pacific continues across its two edges. This lesson uses the seven-continent convention with Australia. Do not call the ocean labels separate bodies of unconnected water.

The map deliberately omits most islands, national borders, distances and fine coastline detail. UK is a locator dot in Europe. Do not use it for navigation or to assess exact boundaries.

Fact sources

National Geographic, Continent: <https://education.nationalgeographic.org/resource/Continent/>

NOAA, How many oceans are there?:

<https://oceanservice.noaa.gov/facts/howmanyoceans.html>

Checked 21 September 2026. SVG shapes and layout are original teaching artwork, not copied from those sources.

Answers and checks

Staff only

Arrival Supported

1. Any land region.
2. Any ocean water area.
3. Europe is beside the UK dot.
4. Atlantic Ocean.

Arrival Standard

1. A round model of Earth.
2. A continent.
3. Europe.
4. Arctic, Atlantic, Indian, Pacific or Southern Ocean.

Arrival Stretch

1. Africa.
2. Atlantic Ocean.
3. The map cuts through one Pacific Ocean; the edges join around Earth.
4. No. It is simplified and not to scale.

Shared activity

1. Europe. The UK dot and callout point to Europe.
2. Africa. Africa is below Europe on this north-up map.
3. Atlantic Ocean. The Atlantic label sits between those land regions.
4. Pacific Ocean. Both edge labels name the same Pacific Ocean.

Check the method

No. Both labels name the same Pacific Ocean. The flat map cuts through the Pacific; there are five named oceans in this lesson.

Assessment and feedback

Individual evidence and next steps

Retain one individually identified continent and one ocean, plus the short exit check. Record whether the learner used a reduced word bank, reading support or a location prompt.

Continents: Africa, Antarctica, Asia, Australia, Europe, North America and South America.

Oceans: Arctic, Atlantic, Indian, Pacific and Southern. The UK is in Europe. Accept any correctly located chosen continent and ocean; check the marker on the labelled reference map. The Pacific at both map edges is one ocean.

Feedback cycle: name the successful step, identify one precise improvement, hear the learner's response about support, then provide a fresh attempt. Use school feedback codes under current policy.

Learner response and evidence source

Support used / content prompts

What is secure / what needs another attempt

Agreed next step and fresh response

Lesson vocabulary

Use these definitions with the lesson and knowledge organiser.

continent — One of the seven large land regions in this lesson.

ocean — One of the five named parts of the connected global ocean.

world map — A flat picture showing places across Earth.

globe — A round model of Earth.